GETTING PAID FOR CLIENT SERVICES

Your Money-Flow Roadmap — Southern Oak Financial & Wellness

Medicaid and health plans do not pay for "advocacy" by itself. They pay for **specific services**, through **enrolled providers**, or through **funded partner organizations**. Here is how you get into that flow, fastest money first.

STEP 1 — THIS WEEK (FREE): HHSC Community Partner Program

1. Go to **texascommunitypartnerprogram.com** and apply as an organization.
2. Take the free state training. Choose the hands-on level, so you can help families apply and renew on YourTexasBenefits — not just hand out flyers.
3. Finish the training and get your official Community Partner designation.

PAYOFF: No check from the state — but this is the trust badge every payer asks about. It brings referrals, and Doors 2–4 take you seriously because the state already vetted you.

STEP 2 — THIS MONTH: Texas Community Health Worker (CHW) Certificate

1. Go to the Texas DSHS website and search "Community Health Worker certification."
2. Two ways in: a 160-hour approved course, **or** the experience pathway if you have 1,000+ hours of community health work in the last 3 years. Your 5 years with special-needs families and 2 years of medication assistance may qualify you — ask DSHS to confirm before paying for any course.
3. Apply, pay the small state fee, and keep the certificate current (16 hours of continuing education every 2 years).

PAYOFF: Clinics and Medicaid health plans can now contract you for navigation and member support — paid by the hour or by the member, steady money, not one-sale-at-a-time.

STEP 3 — MONTHS 1–2: ISS Subcontract (your Route A day-hab plan)

1. Apply for the DAHS-ISS license for your San Antonio site through TULIP (Texas Unified Licensure Information Portal).
2. Pick 2–3 HCS / TxHmL program providers and offer your ISS service for their clients. Your starter pack already has the first call: AACOG IDD Services, (210) 832-5020.
3. Sign a simple subcontract: they bill Medicaid, you provide the service, they pay you from the Medicaid rate.

PAYOFF: Real Medicaid money per service day — the first true contract income, without holding the big state contract yourself.

STEP 4 — MONTHS 2–3: Medicaid Health Plan (MCO) Partnerships

1. Call the community / provider relations teams at the STAR Kids and STAR+PLUS plans: **Superior HealthPlan, Molina Healthcare, UnitedHealthcare Community Plan, Aetna Better Health**.
2. Your pitch, one page: bilingual benefits navigation and application help for their disability families in San Antonio and the Rio Grande Valley. Bring your Community Partner designation, CHW certificate, 2-1-1 listing, and Google profile.
3. Ask for a value-added services or community partner agreement. Start with events and referrals; grow it into a paid scope of work.

PAYOFF: Contract income from the plans themselves — the steadiest flow on this page.

STEP 5 — IN THE BACKGROUND: Vendor Lists

1. Register as a vendor with school districts (SAISD, Northside, North East, and RGV districts) to be paid for parent-training workshops.
2. Ask University Health and large clinics about community navigation partnerships — your CHW certificate is the key that opens these.

PAYOFF: Workshop fees and small contracts that stack on top of everything above.

LATER — 2027: Your Own Medicaid Contract

Once the flow above is running, HHSC open enrollment lets you contract directly as an HCS provider and bill Medicaid yourself (provider training + competency exam + compliance). Big money, big paperwork — a 2027 door, not a today door.

HAVE THESE READY BEFORE YOU APPLY ANYWHERE

• Business name + EIN • W-9 form • Business bank account (for direct deposit) • Your E&O / liability insurance certificate • A one-page “what we do” capability sheet (Rio can build this) • Your 2-1-1 listing and Google profile (both done)

Start with Step 1 this week — it is free, it is fast, and every other door asks for it. Southern Oak Financial & Wellness · southernoakfw@gmail.com · southernoakfw.org